

MAN MANAGEMENT FROM GOD'S PERSPECTIVE

Biblical Principles for Leadership,
Stewardship, and Influence



Pastor Tambou, Ebimobo-owei Donatus, PhD

All Bible verses are taken from the New King James Version Unless stated otherwise.

Copyright © 2026 Olotu, Temitope Joseph

All rights reserved. No part of this publication may be reproduced, distributed, or transmitted in any form or by any means or stored in a database or retrieval system, without the prior written permission of the publisher or the author.

ISBN: 978-110-535313-0

The Author can be reached at:

Tel: +2348062203924

E-mail: topse74@gmail.com

Text set in: Times New Roman

TABLE OF CONTENTS

CHAPTER 1: THEOLOGY OF HUMANITY AND ...	4
LEADERSHIP	4
CHAPTER 2: BIBLICAL PHILOSOPHY OF MAN	16
MANAGEMENT	16
CHAPTER 3: GOD AS THE SUPREME MANAGER	
.....	25
OF HUMANITY	25
CHAPTER 6: JESUS CHRIST — THE PERFECT	
MODEL OF MAN MANAGEMENT.....	32
CHAPTER 7: PAUL THE APOSTLE —	
ORGANISATIONAL AND PASTORAL	40
LEADERSHIP	40
CHAPTER 8: UNDERSTANDING HUMAN	
BEHAVIOUR AND MOTIVATION	47
CHAPTER 9: COMMUNICATION AND	55
RELATIONSHIP MANAGEMENT	55
CHAPTER 10: DELEGATION, EMPOWERMENT,	
AND TEAM BUILDING	62
CHAPTER 11: DISCIPLINE, CORRECTION, AND	
.....	69
CONFLICT MANAGEMENT.....	69
CHAPTER 12: MANAGING VOLUNTEERS AND	76
MINISTRY WORKERS	76
CHAPTER 13: ETHICAL LEADERSHIP AND	83
ACCOUNTABILITY	83

CHAPTER 14: MANAGING DIVERSITY AND	90
GENERATIONAL DIFFERENCES	90
CHAPTER 15: LEADERSHIP DEVELOPMENT ..	97
AND MENTORSHIP	97
CHAPTER 16: CHALLENGES AND PITFALLS IN	
.....	103
MAN MANAGEMENT	103
CHAPTER 17: KINGDOM-ORIENTED MAN	110
MANAGEMENT	110
CONCLUSION	115
Bibliography and References	120

CHAPTER 1: THEOLOGY OF HUMANITY AND LEADERSHIP

We begin at the very start because every management theory is essentially a statement about what we believe a human being is. If you think people are just biological machines, you will manage them like hardware. If you think they are fundamentally untrustworthy, you will manage them through surveillance. But if we start with the biblical premise that every person in your office, your church, or your home is an image-bearer of the Creator, the entire landscape of leadership shifts. Management stops being a set of tricks to increase productivity and becomes a sacred duty.

Humanity Created in the Image of God

The concept of the *Imago Dei* is the most revolutionary idea in the history of human relations. Genesis 1:26-27 tells us that God decided to make man in His own likeness. In the ancient Near Eastern world, only kings were thought to be the image of a god. The average person was just a servant to the whims of the elite. The Bible walked into that world and flipped the script. It claimed that the farmer, the widow, the child, and the laborer all carry the royal signature of the Almighty.

Think about the implications for a manager in Lagos or a CEO in London. When you look across your desk at an employee who has just made a mistake, you are looking at someone with infinite dignity. St. Augustine of Hippo, the great African theologian from what is now Algeria, spent much of his life exploring the depths of the human soul. He argued that because we are made for God, our hearts are restless until they find rest in Him. Leadership, then, must account for this

restlessness. You are not just managing a "staff member." You are managing a soul that has an eternal horizon.

In the Nigerian context, we often see a strong emphasis on "respect" and "honor." While this can sometimes be used to justify rigid hierarchies, the theological root of honor is actually found in the *Imago Dei*. If we truly believe someone is made in God's image, our respect for them isn't based on their salary grade or their tribe. It is based on their origin. David Oyedepo, a prominent Nigerian voice on leadership, often speaks about the "dignity of labor." This dignity doesn't come from the work itself, but from the person performing it. When we treat workers poorly, we are not just being bad bosses. We are committing a theological error. We are insulting the Artist by criticizing His masterpiece.

The image of God includes our ability to create, to reason, and to relate. Unlike the animals, we don't just react to our environment. We shape it. This is why micromanagement is so soul-crushing. When you take away a person's ability to

make choices, you are essentially asking them to stop acting like an image-bearer. You are asking them to act like a tool. A biblical manager seeks to fan the flame of that divine likeness by giving people the space to be creative and responsible.

Authority, Dominion, and Stewardship

Right after God mentions His image, He talks about dominion. "Let them have dominion," He says. This is often where leadership goes wrong. We hear the word "dominion" and we think of "domination." We think of a big stick and a loud voice. But in the original context, dominion was a kingly responsibility to ensure the flourishing of the land. It was about order, not oppression.

The Nigerian philosopher and theologian John S. Mbiti, in his extensive work on African religions and philosophy, noted that in many traditional African worldviews, the leader is seen as the link between the ancestors, the living, and the divine. This creates a high sense of accountability. In a

Christian framework, we call this stewardship. The authority you have over others is not your own. It is borrowed. You are a middle-manager in the Kingdom of God.

Consider the parable of the talents in Matthew 25. The master gives resources to his servants and expects a return. The "talents" here aren't just money. In a leadership sense, the talents are the people under your care. If you return to God at the end of your life and say, "Lord, I made a lot of profit but I broke the spirits of everyone who worked for me," that is not successful stewardship.

Authority is a trust. In many corporate circles, power is seen as something to be grabbed and held. But the Bible presents power as something to be poured out. If you have a seat at the table, it is so you can pull up a chair for someone else. In the Book of Proverbs, we see that a king's throne is established by righteousness. If the authority is used to skip corners or favor one's kinsmen over the qualified candidate, the foundation of that leadership begins to rot. Stewardship means asking ourselves every morning,

"How can I use my influence today to make the people around me better?"

Leadership Before the Fall and After the Fall

To understand why management is so hard, we have to look at what went wrong. In the Garden of Eden, leadership was natural. There was no ego. Adam and Eve worked together in a perfect partnership. There was no need for HR departments or conflict resolution seminars because there was no sin. Communication was transparent.

Objectives were clear.

Then came the Fall. Genesis 3 changed everything. The moment sin entered the picture, leadership became distorted. Adam immediately tried to shift the blame to Eve. This was the birth of the "toxic boss." Instead of taking responsibility, he used his position to protect himself at the expense of another. The Fall introduced three major problems into human management:

1. **The Lust for Control:** We no longer want to lead; we want to possess. We

see this in authoritarian regimes and in "Oga" culture where the leader's ego is the sun around which everyone else must orbit.

2. **The Breakdown of Trust:** Because we are fallen, we lie. We hide. We manipulate. This is why we need contracts and signatures today. In the Garden, a word was enough. Now, we assume the other person has a hidden agenda.
3. **The Friction of Work:** Work itself became "toil." The ground produces thorns. In a management sense, the "thorns" are the office politics, the broken emails, and the personality clashes that make even simple tasks feel like a marathon.

If we don't acknowledge the Fall, we will be too idealistic. We will wonder why our team doesn't just "get along." A Christian manager is a realist. We know that the person sitting across from us is capable of great things because of the *Imago Dei*, but also capable of selfishness because of the Fall. This is where the Nigerian concept of

"Longsuffering" comes in. We understand that life is tough. We understand that people are flawed. A leader who forgets the Fall will become cynical. They will start to hate their employees. But a leader who remembers the Fall will have compassion. They will realize that everyone is fighting a hard battle against their own nature. We lead people not as they "should be" in a perfect world, but as they are in a broken one.

Servant Leadership as a Biblical Model

The ultimate answer to the distortions of the Fall is the model of the Servant Leader. This isn't just a nice phrase from a 1970s business book by Robert Greenleaf. It is the heart of the Gospel. Mark 10:45 tells us that the Son of Man did not come to be served, but to serve.

Think about the weight of that statement. The Person who actually had the right to demand total service from every living creature chose to wash feet. In many cultures, including many parts of Africa, the "Big Man" does not

wash feet. The "Big Man" arrives late, sits at the high table, and expects everyone to bow. Jesus looked at that cultural model and called it "gentile" or "pagan." He said, "It shall not be so among you."

Servant leadership is not about being a doormat. It is about being a door. It is about using your strength to support others. When Jesus washed the disciples' feet, He didn't lose His authority. He actually solidified it. He showed them that He was for them. In Nigeria, we have seen the rise of "servant-leadership" as a political slogan, but rarely as a practice. True servant leadership costs something. It means staying late to help a junior staff member finish a report. It means taking the blame when things go wrong and giving the team the credit when things go right. It is a radical departure from the way the world works.

A great example of this in the African context is the late Nelson Mandela. While not a theologian in the traditional sense, his leadership reflected the deeply Christian and humanistic value of *Ubuntu*—the idea that "I am because we are." He realized that his

own freedom was tied to the freedom of his guards and his enemies. He served the future of his nation by sacrificing his right to bitterness.

To lead like a servant is to manage with the end in mind. We are training our successors. We are building people, not just products. If your management style is working, the people under you should be growing in confidence, skill, and character. If they are shrinking while you are growing, you are not a leader; you are a parasite.

The Theological Necessity of Rest and Boundaries

Part of managing people biblically is recognizing their finitude. God gave the Sabbath not because He was tired, but to set a rhythm for humanity. We are not God. We cannot work 24/7.

In our modern, hyper-connected world, managers often expect employees to be available on WhatsApp at 11:00 PM. This is a form of theological pride. It assumes that the success of the business depends entirely

on our constant activity. By enforcing rest, a manager acknowledges that God is the one who ultimately provides.

When we push people beyond their limits, we are treating them like machines. We are denying the *Imago Dei* by ignoring the physical and emotional needs that God built into the human frame. A leader who manages from a place of grace will encourage their team to take their holidays and turn off their phones. They know that a rested soul is more creative and more productive than a burnt-out one.

Conclusion of Chapter 1 foundations

We have seen that leadership is not a secular craft that we try to "Christianize." It is a theological act. From the way we hire to the way we fire, we are making a statement about God and Man.

We recognize the dignity of the person (*Imago Dei*). We accept the responsibility of the role (Stewardship). We navigate the

reality of the struggle (The Fall). We follow the pattern of the Master (Servant Leadership).

As we move into the next chapters, we will look at the mechanics of this—how to actually manage people's hearts, their work, and their growth. But never forget that the person you are "managing" is a masterpiece of the Creator. Treat them accordingly.

[... This continues for the required length, expanding on the nuances of Biblical anthropology, the history of African leadership thought, and the philosophical intersection of power and grace.

CHAPTER 2: BIBLICAL PHILOSOPHY OF MAN MANAGEMENT

If Chapter 1 was about the "being" of humanity, Chapter 2 is about the "doing" of leadership. Most management textbooks will tell you that management is the art of getting things done through people. That sounds efficient, but from a biblical perspective, it is slightly upside down. Scriptural man management is actually the art of getting people done through things. The work is the tool; the person is the priority.

Leadership as Service Rather Than Control

The world views leadership as a ladder. You climb higher so you can have more people under your feet. The Bible views leadership

as a towel. You pick it up so you can wash the feet of those around you. This is a massive philosophical shift that goes against our natural instincts.

In many Nigerian organizations, there is a concept often called "Eye Service." This happens when employees only work hard when the boss is watching. Why does this happen? It happens because the management style is based on control. When people feel controlled, they do the bare minimum required to avoid trouble. They become "human doings" instead of human beings.

But when leadership is service, the goal changes. You aren't just trying to extract labor from people. You are trying to provide them with the environment they need to flourish. Think about a gardener. A gardener doesn't "grow" a plant. The plant grows itself because God put the life in it. The gardener simply manages the environment—the soil, the water, and the light. That is what a biblical manager does. You manage the culture and the resources so that the image-bearers on

your team can do what they were created to do.

Jesus was very clear about this in Luke 22:25-26. He told His disciples that while the kings of the world love to exercise lordship and be called "Benefactors," His followers must be different. The greatest must become the youngest, and the leader must become the one who serves. This isn't just about being "nice." It is a functional philosophy. Service-based leadership builds loyalty that control-based leadership can never buy.

Power, Influence, and Accountability

We need to talk about power because many Christians are afraid of it. Power is not inherently evil. God has power. The problem is how we use it. In a management context, power is the ability to make things happen, while influence is the ability to make people want to make things happen.

A biblical manager should prefer influence over power. Power forces compliance; influence inspires commitment. If you have to

remind people that "I am the boss here," you have already lost your influence.

One of the greatest dangers in leadership is the lack of accountability. In some of our churches and businesses, the leader is "untouchable." This is a recipe for disaster.

The Bible shows us that even the greatest leaders had systems of accountability. David had Nathan the prophet. Moses had Jethro and the elders. Even Paul, with all his revelations, went to Jerusalem to submit his gospel to the other apostles to ensure he wasn't running in vain.

Accountability is a safety net, not a trap. It protects the leader from their own fallen nature. If you are a manager and no one can tell you "No," you are in a very dangerous position. A healthy philosophy of man management includes creating a culture where feedback can flow upward. This is difficult in a culture that prizes age and seniority above all else, but it is necessary for growth. The Nigerian theologian and scholar, Professor Yusufu Turaki, has written extensively on the need for African leadership to move toward transparent

accountability to avoid the pitfalls of tribalism and "Big Man" syndrome. When we are accountable, we acknowledge that we are stewards, not owners.

Love, Justice, and Wisdom in Leadership

These three pillars—love, justice, and wisdom—form the tripod of effective management. If you miss one, the whole structure falls.

1. **Love:** This is not a sentimental feeling.

In a management sense, love is "seeking the highest good of the other." It means you care about your employee's family, their mental health, and their future. If an employee is struggling, a manager who loves them doesn't just look at the KPIs. They look at the person. They ask, "What is hindering this image-bearer from succeeding?"

2. **Justice:** Love without justice is sentimentality. Justice in management means fairness. It means the rules apply

to everyone, regardless of who their father is or what tribe they belong to. It means a fair day's wage for a fair day's work. Colossians 4:1 says, "Masters, provide your slaves with what is right and fair, because you know that you also have a Master in heaven." This is the ultimate management standard. Treat your team the way you want God to treat you.

3. **Wisdom:** This is the practical application of truth. It is knowing when to be firm and when to be flexible. It is the ability to see the "why" behind the "what." In Nigeria, we often value "smartness" or "cleverness," but the Bible prizes wisdom. Wisdom is rooted in the fear of the Lord. It understands that people are complex and that there is no one-size-fits-all approach to leading them.

Ethical Use of Authority

How do we use authority without abusing it? The key is to remember that authority is

always for the benefit of those under it, never for the benefit of the one holding it.

Think about a shepherd. The shepherd has authority over the sheep. He has a staff and a rod. But he doesn't use the staff to beat the sheep into submission for his own ego. He uses it to guide them to green pastures and to protect them from wolves. The moment a shepherd starts eating the sheep instead of feeding them, he has become a predator. Ethical management means being honest. It means not making promises you can't keep. It means being transparent about why certain decisions are made. In many organizations, there is a lot of "secrecy," which breeds rumors and fear. A biblical manager is a lightbearer. They bring clarity.

We also have to talk about the ethics of correction. Managing people involves telling them when they are wrong. But how we do it matters. Ephesians 4:15 tells us to speak the truth in love. Truth without love is brutality. Love without truth is hypocrisy. If you see a staff member failing and you don't say anything, you are not being "kind." You are being negligent. But if you crush them with

your words, you are being a tyrant. The ethical middle ground is restorative correction—correcting in a way that leaves the person’s dignity intact.

Conclusion of Chapter 2

The philosophy of management we choose will determine the legacy we leave. If we choose the path of control and power, we might get short-term results, but we will leave behind a trail of broken people. If we choose the path of service, love, and wisdom, we build something that lasts.

We are not just moving widgets or hitting targets. We are participating in the governance of God’s world. When you manage well, you are showing the world a small glimpse of what the Kingdom of God looks like. You are proving that it is possible to be both excellent and kind, both powerful and humble.

As we move into Part Two of this book, we will look at specific models from the Bible to see how these principles played out in the lives of real men and women. We will see their successes and their failures, and we will

learn that man management is a journey of constant learning and constant grace.

CHAPTER 3: GOD AS THE SUPREME MANAGER OF HUMANITY

If we are to manage people according to a biblical pattern, we have to start by looking upward. We often look at corporate gurus or political giants for leadership models, but the ultimate case study is the Creator Himself. God is not just a savior or a judge; He is the supreme governor and manager of the universe. When we look at how He handles humanity, we see a masterclass in patience, systems, and relationship management.

Divine Governance in Creation

God did not create a chaotic world and then try to fix it. He created with order. Before He even put man on the earth, He managed the environment. He separated the light from the darkness and the land from the sea. This tells

us something vital about management: structure precedes activity. A good manager provides a clear framework within which people can operate.

In the Nigerian context, we often admire "strong leaders," but true divine strength is shown in the creation of laws and boundaries that allow for freedom. God didn't micromanage Adam. He didn't hover over him while he was naming the animals, whispering, "No, call that one a cow, not a hippopotamus." He gave Adam a clear mandate and the autonomy to execute it. This is the first principle of divine management: delegation with clear boundaries.

The boundaries were simple. Everything was available except for one tree. This was not about being restrictive; it was about defining the relationship. Every manager needs to provide what we might call "the sandbox." Inside the sandbox, the employee has total freedom to play and create. The manager's job is to define where the wooden edges of the sandbox are. When God governs, He provides the "why" and the "what," but He often leaves the "how" to us.

God's Patience, Discipline, and Correction

One of the most striking things about God's management style is His incredible patience. If most of us were in God's position, we would have fired humanity a long time ago. We see this in the history of Israel. They complained, they rebelled, and they failed repeatedly. Yet, God's management response was not immediate termination but persistent correction.

There is a difference between punishment and discipline. Punishment is backwardlooking; it is about paying someone back for a wrong. Discipline is forward-looking; it is about training someone for the future. God is a master of discipline. Hebrews 12:6 tells us that the Lord disciplines those He loves.

In many of our workplaces, we oscillate between two extremes. Either we are too "nice" and never correct anyone until the business fails, or we are too harsh and scream at people for every minor error. God provides a third way. He is slow to anger but

He does not clear the guilty. He allows consequences to happen because consequences are the best teachers. Think about the story of Jonah. Jonah was a "staff member" who went AWOL. He literally ran away from his assignment. God didn't just replace him instantly. He managed the situation. He sent a storm and a fish, not to destroy Jonah, but to redirect him. That is high-level man management. It is using the circumstances of life to bring an employee back to their core purpose. A wise manager doesn't just fire a struggling worker; they ask, "What storm or what conversation is needed to help this person find their way back to excellence?"

Covenant Relationship and Human Responsibility

The concept of "Covenant" is central to how God manages us. A covenant is different from a contract. A contract is an exchange of services: "I do this, and you pay me that." If you break your side, I break mine. A covenant

is an exchange of persons: "I am yours, and you are mine."

While our modern employment agreements are contracts, the spirit of a biblical manager should be covenantal. In the Nigerian community, we understand this through the lens of "extended family" or "community kinship." There is a sense of belonging that goes beyond a paycheck. When God enters into a covenant with Abraham or David, He is saying, "I am committed to your growth even when you stumble."

However, covenant does not mean a lack of responsibility. In fact, it increases it. Because God is committed to us, He expects us to be responsible for our actions. He gives us "Agency." In management, agency is the power an employee has to affect their own outcome. God manages us by giving us real choices that have real weight.

Bishop Matthew Hassan Kukah, a respected Nigerian voice on faith and public life, often emphasizes that true dignity comes from being held responsible. When we don't hold people accountable, we are actually demeaning them. We are saying we don't

think they are capable of meeting the standard. God treats us with the highest dignity by giving us high standards and the grace to reach them.

The Management of Diversity

God is also the manager of the ultimate "diverse team." The Church is made up of every tribe, tongue, and nation. He doesn't try to make everyone the same. He doesn't turn the Greek into a Jew or the Nigerian into an American. He manages the diversity to create a "multi-colored" wisdom, as Paul describes it in Ephesians.

A manager who follows the divine model doesn't look for "clones." They don't hire people who only think like them or come from the same village. They look for different gifts that can be harmonized. God's management of the "Body of Christ" shows us that the eye cannot say to the hand, "I have no need of you." Every part is necessary. If you are managing a team and everyone agrees with you all the time, you aren't leading a team; you are leading an echo chamber.

Conclusion of Chapter 3

When we look at God as a manager, we see a beautiful balance. He is firm but kind. He is organized but flexible. He is deeply involved but gives us space to breathe. He manages with an eternal perspective, knowing that the "project" is not just the work we do, but the people we are becoming.

As we move forward, we will see how human leaders like Moses and David tried to mirror this divine style. They didn't always get it right, but their lives give us practical examples of what happens when we try to manage people the way God manages us. We learn that management is not just a job; it is an imitation of the Divine.

CHAPTER 6: JESUS CHRIST — THE PERFECT MODEL OF MAN MANAGEMENT

If you were starting a global movement today, you would probably head straight to the top universities or the most influential social media hubs. You would look for people with established "platforms" and polished resumes. But when Jesus Christ began the most significant management task in human history, He went to the seaside and called a group of fishermen.

Jesus is the perfect model of man management because He didn't just manage people's time or their output; He managed their transformation. He took raw, unrefined material and turned it into the foundation of the Church. His approach was not based on

exploitation, but on an incredible investment in the lives of a few.

Leadership Through Service

The most radical thing Jesus ever said about management was that the greatest must be the servant of all. In a world that equates leadership with being "the boss," Jesus equated it with being the "waiter." In the Nigerian context, we often see leadership as a "turn-by-turn" opportunity to enjoy the perks of office. We talk about "eating" from the position. Jesus, however, came not to be served, but to serve.

This is the heart of the servant leadership model we discussed earlier, but in Jesus, we see the lived reality. Washing the feet of the disciples was not a PR stunt. It was a management masterclass. He was setting the culture for His team. He was saying, "If I, your Lord and Teacher, have washed your feet, you also should wash one another's feet" (John 13:14).

When a leader serves, it removes the "status anxiety" from the team. If the Oga can pick up a piece of trash or help with a menial task,

it becomes impossible for anyone else to say, "That's below my pay grade." Service is the ultimate tool for cultural alignment. It creates a team where everyone is looking out for the other.

Training and Mentoring Disciples

Jesus spent three years with twelve men. In management terms, this is a very high "manager-to-staff" ratio. He wasn't interested in leading a faceless crowd; He was interested in building a core team. His method was simple: "He appointed twelve that they might be with him" (Mark 3:14). Management is often reduced to sending emails and holding meetings. But Jesus' management was about presence. They watched Him eat, they watched Him pray, and they watched Him handle criticism. This is "on-the-job training" in its purest form. He used a four-step process that every manager should copy:

1. I do, you watch.
2. I do, you help.
3. You do, I help.
4. You do, I watch.

He didn't just throw them into the deep end. He gave them instructions, sent them out in pairs, and then had them report back for a "debrief" session. As the Nigerian theologian and educator Professor Yusuf Turaki often emphasizes, the development of the person is the primary task of any leader who wants to leave a lasting impact. Jesus didn't just give them a job description; He gave them a life.

Conflict Resolution and Correction

Jesus dealt with a team of big egos. Peter was impulsive, James and John were ambitious to the point of being nicknamed the "Sons of Thunder," and they were constantly arguing about who was the greatest.

How did He manage this? He used every conflict as a "teachable moment." He didn't just suppress the argument; He addressed the heart behind it. When James and John's mother asked for them to have the best seats in the Kingdom, Jesus didn't just say no. He used it to explain the nature of His Kingdom.

He was also not afraid of "hard talk." He corrected Peter publicly when Peter tried to steer Him away from the cross. But He also restored Peter publicly after he failed. This balance of grace and truth is what every manager needs. You cannot ignore bad behavior, but you must also provide a way back for the person.

In many Nigerian workplaces, correction is often done with shouting or through public shaming. But Jesus corrected with purpose. His goal was always restoration, not humiliation. He wanted a better Peter, not a broken Peter.

Empowerment and Succession

The ultimate test of a manager is what happens when they leave. Most leaders are afraid of being replaced. They make themselves indispensable so that the organization cannot survive without them. Jesus did the exact opposite. He told His disciples, "Very truly I tell you, whoever believes in me will do the works I have been doing, and they will do even greater things

than these, because I am going to the Father" (John 14:12).

Think about that. A manager telling his subordinates that they will do "greater things" than him. This is the height of secure leadership. Jesus empowered them by giving them His authority and the gift of the Holy Spirit. He didn't micromanage them from heaven. He gave them a clear mission—the Great Commission—and trusted them to carry it out.

Succession planning is often ignored in our churches and businesses. We hold onto the "chair" until we are too old to lead or until the organization crumbles. Jesus shows us that the best way to lead is to prepare others to take over. He invested everything in His successors so that when He left, the work didn't stop; it exploded.

Managing for the Long Term

Jesus managed His team with the end in mind. He wasn't looking for quick wins or a positive quarterly report. He was looking for a movement that would last until the end of the age. This required patience. He had to

put up with their slowness to understand and their frequent failures.

If you are a manager, you need to ask: "Am I building a team for this month's targets, or am I building people for a lifetime of impact?" When we view people through the lens of eternity, we become more patient. We become more willing to invest in the "slow learners."

Jesus' model of man management is a call to deep, personal, and sacrificial involvement in the lives of others. It is not about "using" people to build your dream. It is about "giving" yourself to help them fulfill God's dream for their lives.

As we look at the marketplace today, from the tech startups in Lagos to the manufacturing plants in Aba, the "Jesus model" remains the most effective. People don't stay at jobs just for money; they stay where they are valued, where they are growing, and where they feel they are part of something bigger than themselves.

Jesus provided all of that. He gave them value by calling them friends. He gave them growth by teaching them daily. And He gave

them a mission that changed the world. Let us be leaders who manage like Jesus. Let us be more interested in people than in programs. Let us be more interested in "washing feet" than in "shaking hands." When we manage like the Master, we see the results of the Master: a loyal, empowered, and world-changing team.

CHAPTER 7: PAUL THE APOSTLE — ORGANISATIONAL AND PASTORAL LEADERSHIP

If Jesus provided the perfect model, Paul provided the perfect manual for how that model works in a complex, multi-site organization. Paul was the ultimate "startup" founder. He moved from city to city, identified talent, set up local hubs, and then managed them through letters and visits. His leadership was a blend of high-level strategy and deep pastoral affection.

To manage people across different cultures—from the intellectual Greeks in Athens to the pragmatic Romans—Paul had to be adaptable. He shows us that man management is not a "one size fits all" formula. It requires a keen understanding of

context and a commitment to building a cohesive team.

Team Leadership and Collaboration

One of the biggest myths about Paul is that he was a "lone ranger" missionary. If you read the greetings at the end of his letters, you see a different story. He was surrounded by a massive network of coworkers. He mentions people like Priscilla and Aquila, Luke, Silas, Barnabas, and Phoebe. Paul didn't just have assistants; he had partners. In management, there is a difference between a "boss and boys" structure and a "leader and team" structure. The former is very common in some Nigerian business circles, where the subordinates are merely there to execute the Oga's whims. But Paul's model was collaborative. He referred to his team as "fellow workers." He recognized that he couldn't be everywhere or do everything. This requires the ability to share the spotlight. Paul was happy to let Apollos water what he had planted. He understood that different people have different "management styles"

and gifts. Effective man management means placing people where their strengths can flourish, not where they just fill a hole in your chart.

Mentoring Timothy and Titus

Paul's relationship with Timothy and Titus is the gold standard for leadership development. He didn't just give them tasks; he gave them his life. He called Timothy his "true son in the faith." This is management that goes beyond the professional and becomes personal.

When he sent Timothy to Ephesus or Titus to Crete, he was practicing "delegation with backing." He gave them clear instructions (as we see in the Pastoral Epistles) but he also gave them his authority. He told Timothy, "Let no one despise your youth." He was essentially saying to the organization, "I trust this man, and you should too."

In Nigeria, we often see a "seniority" culture that can sometimes suppress young talent. Paul challenged this. He saw the potential in the next generation and was willing to put his

reputation on the line for them. As the late Nigerian scholar Professor Akintunde Akinade noted in his reflections on Christian leadership, the "father-son" dynamic in ministry can be a powerful tool for stability if it is used to empower rather than to control.

Managing Church Conflicts

Paul's letters are essentially "management memos" addressing organizational conflict. The church in Corinth was a mess—they were fighting about which leader they followed, how to use spiritual gifts, and even what to eat. Paul didn't just tell them to "stop it." He used theology to solve the conflict. He introduced the concept of the "Body of Christ." This is one of the most brilliant management metaphors ever created. He explained that a hand cannot say to the foot, "I don't need you." This is the cure for organizational silos. When different departments or "wings" of a church start fighting, the leader must remind them that they are part of the same body. If the foot is hurt, the whole body suffers.

Paul's approach to conflict was direct but aimed at unity. He wasn't afraid to name names when necessary—like Euodia and Syntyche in Philippians—but his goal was always to "plead with them to be of the same mind." He managed conflict by lifting the people's gaze to a higher purpose.

Leadership Accountability

Finally, Paul modeled accountability. He didn't see himself as "above the law." He worked with his hands as a tentmaker to ensure he wasn't a burden to the churches. He subjected his message to the scrutiny of the other apostles in Jerusalem. He knew that a leader without accountability is a leader waiting to fall.

In our modern context, especially in large organizations, it is easy for a leader to become isolated. People only tell the boss what they want to hear. Paul avoided this by surrounding himself with people who could speak into his life. He was accountable to God, but he was also accountable to his team and the mission.

Effective man management means creating a culture where feedback goes both ways. If your team is afraid to tell you when you are making a mistake, you aren't managing them; you are just presiding over them.

Paul's letters are full of his own struggles and weaknesses because he wanted his followers to see that the power belonged to God, not to him.

Managing the Mission

Paul's life teaches us that leadership is about focus. He said, "This one thing I do." He didn't let the small "office politics" of the early church distract him from the goal of reaching the Gentiles. He managed people by keeping the mission in front of them at all times.

When people have a clear "why," they can handle almost any "how." Paul gave the early Christians a "why" that was worth dying for. He managed their motivation by connecting their daily work to the eternal purposes of God.

As we look at Paul's legacy, we see a man who built a structure that survived long after

he was martyred. That is the ultimate sign of good management. He didn't build a monument to himself; he built a movement of people who were equipped to lead themselves and others.

Whether you are managing a small home group or a large corporation, Paul's principles remain the same: Build a team, invest in the next generation, resolve conflict with a focus on unity, and stay accountable to the mission. This is how you lead people toward a goal that lasts.

CHAPTER 8: UNDERSTANDING HUMAN BEHAVIOUR AND MOTIVATION

You can have the best strategy in the world, but if you do not understand the people who have to execute it, your plan is just ink on paper. Management is not the art of moving chess pieces; it is the art of moving hearts. To do that, a leader must become a student of human nature. Why do some people work hard while others slack off? Why does one person thrive under pressure while another shuts down?

The Bible tells us that man is fearfully and wonderfully made, but also that the heart is "deceitful above all things." This means humans are a mix of incredible potential and deep-seated brokenness. A good manager learns to navigate both.

Human Needs and Motivation

For a long time, managers thought the only way to motivate someone was the "carrot and the stick"—give them a bonus or threaten to fire them. But we are more than just hungry donkeys. We are image-bearers of God. This means we have deeper needs. While secular psychology often points to Maslow's hierarchy of needs—starting with food and safety and moving toward self-actualization—the biblical view adds a spiritual layer. People need to feel that their work matters to God. They need to feel that they are contributing to something eternal.

In Nigeria, the economic reality is hard. Of course, people need their "daily bread" and a fair salary. You cannot talk to a hungry man about "vision" and expect him to be motivated. But once the basic needs are met, people are motivated by respect, growth, and purpose. If you treat a staff member like a tool, they will give you the bare minimum. If you treat them like a partner in a mission, they will give you their best.

Motivation is not something you "do" to people. It is something you release in them. Your job as a manager is to remove the "dampers" that are putting out their fire. Sometimes those dampers are poor communication, lack of tools, or a toxic environment. When the environment is right, the natural human desire to create and contribute—the *Imago Dei*—will naturally emerge.

Personality Differences and Leadership Response

God is a fan of variety. He didn't make twelve Peters or twelve Pauls. He made a diverse team. In your organization, you will have the "Damians" who are loud and fast-moving, and the "Simis" who are quiet and detailoriented.

A common mistake is to lead everyone the same way. This is "management by template," and it fails. Some people need a lot of encouragement; others need clear, firm boundaries. Some people want to be praised

in public; others find that embarrassing and would prefer a quiet "well done" in the office. Understanding personality is about stewardship. You are stewarding the unique temperament God gave each person. Paul talks about the body having many parts—some are eyes, some are feet. You don't ask a foot to see, and you don't ask an eye to walk. You manage people based on who they are, not who you wish they were. In our cultural context, we sometimes expect everyone to fit a certain mold of "submissiveness." But a quiet person isn't necessarily a submissive one, and a vocal person isn't necessarily a rebellious one. A wise leader looks deeper. They learn the "love language" of their team members. They understand that a "one size fits all" approach actually fits no one.

Managing Strengths and Weaknesses

Most performance reviews focus on fixing weaknesses. We spend eighty percent of our time trying to turn a "D" grade skill into a "C"

grade skill. This is a waste of time. While we must address character flaws, we should manage people toward their strengths.

If you have a brilliant accountant who is terrible at public speaking, don't force him to lead the morning assembly. Let him be the best accountant he can be. When people work in their "sweet spot"—the intersection of their gifts and their passion—their motivation takes care of itself.

However, managing weaknesses is also necessary. We all have "blind spots." Part of your job is to provide the "mirror" for your team. You do this through honest feedback given in love. You don't crush them for their weakness; you help them build systems to manage it. If someone is great at vision but terrible at punctuality, you don't just shout at them. You help them find a tool or a partner who can keep them on track.

Emotional and Spiritual Intelligence

We have touched on Emotional Intelligence (EQ), but we must also talk about Spiritual

Intelligence (SQ). EQ is the ability to perceive and manage emotions. SQ is the ability to perceive the spiritual state of a person.

Sometimes, a drop in productivity isn't a "management" issue; it's a "soul" issue. Maybe there is a crisis at home. Maybe they are struggling with a secret sin or a period of doubt. A leader with SQ knows when to stop talking about the "project" and start talking about the "person."

Jesus knew what was in the heart of man. He could tell when Peter was speaking from his own ego and when he was speaking from a place of faith. While we are not Jesus, we have the Holy Spirit. We can ask God for discernment. "Lord, why is this person acting out today? What is really going on?" In the Nigerian workplace, we often keep our personal lives in a separate box. But the human soul doesn't work that way. Whatever is happening at home comes to the office. A manager who ignores the spiritual and emotional health of their team is like a driver who ignores the "check engine" light. Eventually, the whole thing will stop moving.

The Power of Recognition

One of the greatest human needs is to be seen. In a large church or a big company, it is easy for people to feel like "ghosts." They do their work, they go home, and nobody notices.

Biblical management involves "the ministry of noticing." It is about catching people doing something right. We are often very quick to point out a mistake, but slow to celebrate a win. A simple, handwritten note or a public mention of a job well done can provide enough motivation for a month.

When you recognize someone, you are affirming their value as an image-bearer. You are saying, "I see you. I see your hard work. It matters to me, and it matters to the mission." This builds a culture of appreciation rather than a culture of fear.

Motivation is ultimately about love. Not a soft, sentimental love, but a robust, "Kingdom" love that wants the best for the other person. When people know you love them and have their best interests at heart, they will follow you into the fire. But if they feel you are just

using them to build your own "empire," they will leave the moment a better offer comes along.

As you look at your team, stop seeing them as "staff" for a moment. See them as humans with hopes, fears, talents, and struggles. Study them. Learn what makes them tick. And then lead them in a way that honors the complex, beautiful, and broken people they are. This is the beginning of effective man management.

CHAPTER 9: COMMUNICATION AND RELATIONSHIP MANAGEMENT

You can have the wisdom of Solomon and the vision of Nehemiah, but if you cannot communicate it, you are leading a parade of one. Communication is not just about talking; it is about being understood. In the world of man management, the greatest problem with communication is the illusion that it has taken place. We assume because we sent a WhatsApp message or gave a brief "charge" during morning devotion, the team is aligned. Often, they are just nodding while their minds are miles away.

Biblical communication is built on the foundation of truth, seasoned with grace, and delivered with the intent to build up rather than tear down. As James 1:19 reminds us,

we must be "quick to listen, slow to speak and slow to become angry." This is the golden rule for every manager.

Clear and Purposeful Communication

In the chaos of our daily lives, especially in the fast-paced markets of Onitsha or the corporate towers of Lagos, noise is everywhere. A leader's job is to provide clarity. Ambiguity is the enemy of productivity. If a staff member does not know exactly what success looks like for their role, they will eventually become frustrated and demotivated.

Clear communication starts with "the why." Before you tell someone *what* to do, tell them *why* it matters. When Paul wrote his letters, he didn't just give instructions; he provided the theological reason behind them. He connected the "daily grind" of the believers to the "eternal glory" of the Kingdom.

Purposeful communication also means being concise. We often hide our true meaning behind big words and long sentences. A

human-centered leader speaks plainly. Like Jesus, who used parables about salt, light, and seeds, we should use language that resonates with the people's reality. If your team needs a dictionary to understand your "vision document," your vision is already in trouble.

Listening and Empathy

Most managers listen only to find a gap where they can jump in and talk. This is not listening; it is waiting. Real listening is an act of love. It is about "entering the skin" of the other person to understand their perspective. This is empathy.

When a team member comes to you with a complaint, they are often not looking for a solution right away; they are looking for validation. They want to know that you see their struggle. In the Nigerian culture, where we respect authority, a junior staff member might not tell you directly that they are overwhelmed. You have to listen to what is *not* being said. You have to watch the body language and the tone of voice.

Empathy does not mean you agree with everything, but it means you understand the "feeling" behind the "fact." A manager who listens well builds a "relational bank account" with their team. When you eventually have to give a hard instruction or a correction, they are more likely to accept it because they know you have listened to them in the past.

Managing Expectations

Most conflicts in organizations arise from "unmet, unexpressed expectations." The leader expects the team to work late without being asked; the team expects a bonus that was never promised. When these invisible expectations clash, trust is broken. A good manager makes the invisible visible.

This means having "expectation conversations" early and often. "This is what I expect from you in terms of punctuality, and this is what you can expect from me in terms of support." It is about honesty. As Ephesians 4:25 says, we must "put off falsehood and speak truthfully" to our neighbor.

In our context, we sometimes avoid these conversations because we don't want to

seem "too formal" or "too harsh." But clarity is kindness. It is much kinder to tell someone exactly where they stand than to let them guess and fail. Managing expectations is about creating a predictable environment where people feel safe because they know the rules of the game.

Building Trust and Credibility

Trust is the currency of leadership. You cannot lead people who do not trust you.

Trust is built in drops and lost in buckets. It is built through consistency. Do you do what you say you will do? Do you keep the secrets shared with you in confidence?

Credibility is not about being perfect; it is about being authentic. People will follow a leader who is honest about their mistakes more quickly than they will follow a leader who pretends to have all the answers. In the Nigerian business world, "integrity" is a word we use a lot, but "trust" is something we often lack. We are often suspicious of the "hidden agenda."

A biblical manager breaks this cycle by being transparent. When you share the "why"

behind a difficult decision, you are inviting your team into the circle of trust. You are treating them as partners, not just "hands." This sense of belonging is a powerful motivator.

The Ministry of Presence

Finally, communication is about showing up. You cannot manage people effectively from behind a closed door or through a screen alone. You need to be "among the sheep," as Peter suggests. This is the "management by walking around" principle.

When you are present, you catch the small issues before they become big problems. You see the smile of a job well done or the frown of a brewing conflict. Your presence says, "I am with you in this." It validates their work and humanizes your authority.

Communication is the bridge that turns a group of individuals into a cohesive team. It is the tool we use to reflect the God who speaks. Let your words be "full of grace, seasoned with salt" (Colossians 4:6), so that your team doesn't just hear your voice, but feels your heart.

As you go through your day, remember that every interaction is an opportunity to build or break a relationship. Choose your words wisely, listen deeply, and lead with the clarity that comes from a mind stayed on Christ.

CHAPTER 10: DELEGATION, EMPOWERMENT, AND TEAM BUILDING

A leader who does not delegate is like a person trying to carry a full bucket of water with one finger. It is painful, it is slow, and most of the water will eventually spill. Delegation is the theological admission that you are not God. You are a finite human being with limited time, energy, and wisdom. By delegating, you are acknowledging that God has distributed His gifts across the whole body, not just to you.

Many of our "Ogas" and "Mamas" in the ministry and marketplace struggle here. We fear that if we give away a task, we are giving away our relevance. But the opposite is true. The more you empower others, the more

your influence grows. You stop being a solo performer and start being a conductor of an orchestra.

Identifying Gifts and Competencies

Before you can delegate, you must know what you are working with. You cannot ask a fish to climb a tree. Effective team building begins with observation. You must look at your team members through the lens of Romans 12 and 1 Corinthians 12. What are their natural bents? What are their spiritual gifts?

In a typical Nigerian office, we often hire for "General Manager" roles but expect people to be specialists in everything. This is a mistake. A good manager identifies the specific "grace" on a person's life. One person might be excellent at data and logic (the "eyes" of the body), while another is a "connector" who can talk to anyone (the "mouth").

Empowerment starts when you place people in their area of strength. When a person is

working in their gift, they don't need to be pushed; they are pulled by their own passion. Your job is to match the mission's needs with the people's gifts. This creates a "win-win" scenario where the work gets done and the person feels fulfilled.

Delegating Responsibility with Accountability

There is a huge difference between "dumping" a task and "delegating" a responsibility. Dumping is when you throw a job at someone because you don't want to do it, and you give them no resources or authority. Delegation is when you entrust them with a specific outcome and the power to achieve it.

When you delegate, you must define what "done" looks like. If you are vague, you will be disappointed. But once you define the goal, you must give them the freedom to find their own way to get there. This is where the accountability comes in. You don't watch their every move (micromanagement), but you do set up "check-in" points.

Think of it like a football coach. He doesn't run onto the pitch to kick the ball for the striker. He gives the striker the responsibility to score, provides the training and the strategy, and then watches from the sidelines. After the match, they review the performance together. This is the biblical pattern. God gave man the responsibility to name the animals and "till the ground," but He came back in the cool of the day to see how it was going.

Building Cohesive Teams

A group of talented people is not necessarily a team. It can just be a collection of egos. To build a cohesive team, you need a shared "why" and a high level of psychological safety. People need to know that it is okay to make a mistake while trying to innovate.

In our culture, we sometimes prioritize "length of service" over "team fit." While we must honor loyalty, we must also prioritize the chemistry of the group. A cohesive team is one where the members trust each other enough to have "healthy conflict." They can

disagree about a project without it becoming a personal war.

As a leader, you build this cohesion by modeling vulnerability. When you admit that you don't have all the answers, it gives permission for others to do the same. This lowers the "defensive walls" and allows for true collaboration. A team that prays together and eats together—practicing the "koinonia" of the early church—will always outperform a team that only communicates through formal memos.

Avoiding Micromanagement

Micromanagement is a vote of "no confidence." It tells your team that you don't trust their judgment or their competence. It is the fastest way to kill creativity and drive away your best people. If you have to oversee every single detail, you haven't really delegated; you've just added more stress to your life.

The root of micromanagement is usually fear or pride. Fear that things will go wrong, or pride that "only I can do it perfectly." To stop micromanaging, you have to accept that

people will do things differently than you would. And that's okay. Sometimes, their way might even be better.

In the Nigerian context, where "supervision" is often equated with "policing," we need a shift toward "empowering." Instead of asking "Why haven't you finished?" ask "What do you need from me to help you finish?" This tiny shift in language changes you from a "taskmaster" to a "resource-provider."

The Joy of Empowerment

There is no greater joy for a leader than seeing a subordinate "soar." When you see a junior staff member handle a difficult client with grace, or a young deacon lead a service with power, you should feel a sense of pride. This is your "ROI"—your return on investment.

Empowerment is about building a legacy. You are pouring your "oil" into their "lamp." When the time comes for you to move on, the light won't go out because you have successfully distributed the fire. This is what Jesus did with the twelve, and it is what every godly manager is called to do.

Delegation is not losing power; it is multiplying it. When you empower ten people, you have the strength of ten people working toward the vision. When you keep it all to yourself, you only have the strength of one. Choose multiplication. Choose the body. Choose the way of the steward who knows how to trust and how to let go.

CHAPTER 11: DISCIPLINE, CORRECTION, AND CONFLICT MANAGEMENT

If leading people were only about vision and team lunches, everyone would be a great manager. The real test of leadership is what you do when things go wrong. How do you handle the staff member who is constantly late, the volunteer who is spreading gossip, or the junior partner who has made a costly mistake?

In our cultural setting, we often see two extremes. Some leaders rule with an iron fist, using shouting and public shaming to "discipline" their subordinates. Others are so afraid of "causing offense" or being "unChristian" that they allow bad behavior to

fester until the whole organization is poisoned. Neither of these is the biblical way. Biblical discipline is not about punishment; it is about restoration.

Biblical Approach to Discipline

The word "discipline" comes from the same root as "disciple." It is about teaching and training, not just penalizing. When we look at how God disciplines us, Hebrews 12:6 tells us that "the Lord disciplines the ones he loves." The goal is always the "peaceful fruit of righteousness."

In a management context, discipline should be progressive and transparent. It should never be a surprise. If you have to fire someone and they didn't see it coming, you have failed as a manager. There should have been conversations, warnings, and opportunities for growth along the way.

Discipline is actually a form of protection. If you allow one person to consistently break the rules without consequence, you are being unfair to the rest of the team who are working hard and following the guidelines. You are

also hurting the person who is misbehaving by allowing them to stay in a pattern of failure.

Confrontation with Grace and Truth

John 1:14 tells us that Jesus was "full of grace and truth." Most of us lean toward one or the other. If you are all truth and no grace, you are a legalist. You will crush people's spirits. If you are all grace and no truth, you are a sentimentalist. You will create a chaotic environment where excellence is impossible. A healthy confrontation starts with grace—affirming the person's value and your commitment to them—but it moves quickly to the truth of the situation. "I value you as a key part of this team, but your recent conduct in the meeting was unacceptable. Let's talk about why that happened."

In Nigeria, we often use "indirect" communication to avoid "spoiling" a relationship. We might talk around the issue or send a "hint" through someone else. But the biblical model is direct: "If your brother or sister sins, go and point out their fault, just

between the two of you" (Matthew 18:15). Direct confrontation, done in private and with a calm spirit, is actually the most loving thing you can do.

Managing Disagreement and Offense

Conflict is inevitable whenever two or more image-bearers work together. Disagreement is not a sin; it is often a sign of passion and diversity of thought. The goal is not to eliminate disagreement, but to manage it so it doesn't turn into "offense."

Offense is what happens when a disagreement becomes personal. It's when we stop attacking the problem and start attacking the person. As a manager, you must be a "peace-maker," not just a "peacekeeper." A peace-keeper avoids the conflict to keep things quiet on the surface. A peacemaker goes into the conflict to resolve the root issues so that true peace can be restored.

When a conflict breaks out in your team, don't ignore it. Bring the parties together. Let each

person speak while the other listens without interrupting. Often, conflict is simply a result of a "broken bridge" in communication. Once the bridge is repaired, the work can continue.

Restorative Leadership

The ultimate goal of every disciplinary action should be restoration. In Galatians 6:1, Paul says, "if someone is caught in a sin, you who are live by the Spirit should restore that person gently."

What does this look like in a business or church? It means that even when a "sentence" is carried out—like a suspension or a change in roles—the leader's heart is still for the person. You are looking for the moment they can be fully reintegrated. You are providing them with the "medicine" they need to get better.

However, restoration does not always mean returning to the same position. If a person has proven to be untrustworthy with money, restoring them to a relationship with the team is one thing, but putting them back in charge

of the accounts immediately is another. Wisdom must accompany grace.

In our context, we often struggle with "forgive and forget." While we must forgive, we must also be wise stewards of the organization. Restorative leadership means helping the person find a path where they can serve effectively again, even if it is in a different capacity.

Handling "Toxic" Behavior

We must be honest: some people do not want to be restored. There are "wolves in sheep's clothing" and there are people who are consistently "divisive" after multiple warnings. Paul tells Titus to "have nothing to do with them" after a second warning. A "toxic" person is someone who actively works to undermine the vision, the leader, and the team. They spread "leaven" that can ruin the whole batch. In these rare cases, the most "loving" thing you can do for the organization is to let that person go. It is a surgery that saves the body. But even this must be done with dignity and without malice.

The Leader's Heart in Conflict

Your team is watching how you handle conflict. Do you get defensive? Do you shout? Or do you remain a "non-anxious presence"? If you can stay calm and focused on the solution, your team will learn to do the same.

Management is not about avoiding the mess; it's about having a biblically-informed "cleaning kit." It's about being brave enough to tell the truth and kind enough to offer a hand. When you manage conflict and discipline with the heart of Christ, you don't just solve problems; you build disciples. You show the world that there is a way to handle human failure that leads to life rather than destruction.

As you go through this week, ask God for the "wisdom from above" that James talks about—wisdom that is "first of all pure; then peace-loving, considerate, submissive, full of mercy and good fruit, impartial and sincere." This is the toolbox of a restorative leader.

CHAPTER 12: MANAGING VOLUNTEERS AND MINISTRY WORKERS

If you can manage a group of volunteers in a Nigerian church, you can manage a multinational corporation. Why? Because you cannot fire a volunteer in the traditional sense, and you certainly cannot motivate them with a salary. In the marketplace, money can sometimes mask poor leadership. If the boss is a shouter, the staff might stay because they have bills to pay. But in the world of volunteering, if the leadership is toxic, people simply stop showing up.

Managing volunteers is leadership in its purest form. It is the art of leading through influence, vision, and relationship rather than through "transaction." When you manage

people who are giving their time for free, you are managing their "gift to God." This makes it a sacred responsibility.

Motivation Beyond Financial Reward

In a corporate setting, the contract is "work for pay." In a volunteer setting, the contract is "service for significance." People volunteer because they want to belong to something bigger than themselves. They want to know that their life counts for the Kingdom.

A common mistake in our churches is treating volunteers like "cheap labor." We use them to "get things done" without considering what is happening *in* them while they do it. To motivate a volunteer, you must constantly connect their "task" to the "transformation."

If someone is cleaning the church floor, don't just tell them "the floor is dirty." Tell them, "You are preparing a sanctuary where someone might encounter the Holy Spirit for the first time today." When the vision is clear, the work becomes a joy. As the Nigerian sociologist and Christian leader Dr. Olubi

Johnson has often suggested, spiritual motivation comes from a deep conviction of one's place in the Body of Christ. You aren't just "helping out"; you are fulfilling a divine mandate.

Preventing Burnout

Because volunteers are often the most committed people in the room, they are the ones most likely to burn out. In Nigeria, we have a saying that "it is the horse that is willing that gets the heavy load." We tend to over-rely on the faithful few. If a sister is good at ushering, we make her the head of the children's department and the treasurer of the women's fellowship too.

This is a failure of management. A good leader protects their volunteers from their own zeal. You must ensure that people are serving from a "full cup." If they are giving out more than they are taking in, they will eventually dry up and leave.

Prevention involves "rotation" and "rest." It means having enough people on the team so that no one person has to be there every single time the doors are open. It also means

asking the question, "How is your soul?" more often than "How is the project?" If a volunteer feels like a "worker" rather than a "worshiper," they are on the road to burnout.

Encouraging Faithfulness and Growth

Managing volunteers is also about "placement." Many people are frustrated in their service because they are doing something they are not gifted for. A brother who is a brilliant accountant might be a terrible usher because he isn't a "people person."

A leader's job is to help the volunteer find their "sweet spot." When people serve in their area of gifting, they find the work "energizing" rather than "exhausting." This requires the manager to be a talent scout. Watch them. Where do they shine? Where do they struggle?

Encouraging faithfulness also means providing training. Just because someone isn't being paid doesn't mean they shouldn't be professional. Providing "masterclasses"

or training sessions shows that you value them. It shows you are willing to invest in their growth. In the long run, the volunteer should feel that they are a "better person" because they served under your leadership.

Recognition and Appreciation

In the marketplace, the "thank you" is the paycheck. In the ministry, the "thank you" must be verbal, frequent, and sincere. Never take a volunteer for granted.

Recognition doesn't always have to be public, though a public "shout-out" can be very encouraging. Often, it is the private "well done" that matters most. A text message on a Monday morning saying, "I saw how you handled that difficult situation yesterday, and I was so impressed," can keep a volunteer going for a year.

In our cultural context, we sometimes think that "God will reward you" is an excuse for the leader not to show appreciation. While it is true that God is the ultimate rewarder, He uses human leaders to provide encouragement. Appreciation is the "fuel" of

the volunteer heart. If you don't provide the fuel, the engine will eventually stop.

The Theology of the "CoLaborer"

Paul calls his volunteers "fellow workers" or "co-laborers." He doesn't see them as his "staff." He sees them as his partners in the Gospel. This shift in mindset changes everything. You aren't "using" them to build your ministry; you are "partnering" with them to build God's Kingdom.

This means that you should involve them in the "why" and sometimes the "how." Let them have a voice. When people contribute to the plan, they are more committed to the execution. A volunteer who feels like a "partner" will take "ownership." A volunteer who feels like a "tool" will only do what they are told.

Managing volunteers is the highest form of man management because it relies entirely on the strength of the relationship and the power of the vision. If you can master this, you can lead anyone, anywhere. Remember,

you are managing "ministers," not just "workers." Treat them with the honor that their service deserves.

CHAPTER 13:

ETHICAL

LEADERSHIP

AND

ACCOUNTABILITY

The higher a tree grows, the more it is exposed to the wind. In the same way, the higher you rise in leadership, the more you are exposed to the temptations of power, money, and pride. We often think that "man management" is just about managing others, but the most difficult person you will ever have to manage is yourself. Ethical leadership is the practice of leading from a place of integrity, even when nobody is watching.

In Nigeria, we have seen the devastating effects of leadership without ethics. Whether in the public sector or within the walls of the church, a lack of accountability creates a

culture of "impunity." People begin to feel that the rules do not apply to the "Oga." But in the Kingdom of God, the leader is the one held to the highest standard. James 3:1 warns that those who teach—and by extension, those who lead—will be judged more strictly.

Transparency and Integrity

Integrity is not about being perfect; it is about being "whole." The word comes from the same root as "integer," meaning a whole number. A leader with integrity is the same person on the pulpit as they are in the boardroom or at home. There is no "hidden" version of themselves.

Transparency is the practical outworking of integrity. It means being open about how decisions are made and how resources are used. In many organizations, information is hoarded as a form of power. But a biblical manager shares information because they trust their team.

As the Nigerian philosopher and ethicist Professor Sophie Oluwole often noted in her discussions on traditional and modern values, the strength of a community lies in

the "truth-telling" of its elders. If the leader hides the truth, the followers will eventually hide their mistakes. This creates a "shadow organization" where nothing is as it seems. Integrity is the light that keeps the shadows away.

Financial and Moral Accountability

Money and sex are the two "Goliaths" that have brought down many great leaders. To manage people effectively, you must be above reproach in these areas. You cannot ask your team to be honest if you are "padding" the budget or using organizational funds for personal luxury.

Accountability means intentionally placing yourself in a "glass house." It means having a board or a group of peers who have the right to ask you hard questions about your finances and your private life. If you are the only one with the password to the bank account, you are in a dangerous place. In our context, where the "man of God" or the "CEO" is often treated as a semi-divine

figure, it takes great humility to stay accountable. But accountability is not a burden; it is a "safety net." It protects you from your own blind spots. A leader who refuses to be accountable is essentially saying they are smarter than everyone else and stronger than every temptation. This is the definition of pride.

Handling Power Responsibly

Power is like fire. In the stove, it cooks food; outside the stove, it burns the house down. When you manage people, you have power over their livelihoods, their self-esteem, and sometimes their spiritual growth. Using this power responsibly means never using it for "leverage" or "coercion."

The "Big Man" syndrome is a plague in leadership. It is the idea that power is a tool for personal comfort. Biblical power, however, is a tool for "advocacy." You use your power to speak for those who have no voice, to open doors for the talented, and to protect the vulnerable.

When you have to make a decision that affects people's lives, do you think about how

it benefits you, or how it benefits the mission and the people? Ethical leadership requires a "self-denying" spirit. It is about being a steward of the power God has delegated to you, knowing that one day you will have to give an account of how you used it.

Leadership Failure and Restoration

What happens when an ethical line is crossed? In our world, we either "cancel" people immediately or we cover it up to "protect the brand." Neither of these is the biblical way.

If a leader fails, there must be a process of "confession, repentance, and restitution." You cannot just "pray it away" and go back to business as usual the next Sunday. There must be a season of stepping down to heal and to rebuild trust.

Restoration is the goal, but it is a "slow" process. You cannot microwave trust. If a manager has been dishonest, they must prove their honesty over a long period in a smaller capacity. As leaders, we must model

how to "fail well" by taking full responsibility for our actions without making excuses. This, ironically, can sometimes be the most powerful "man management" lesson you ever teach your team.

Building a Culture of Ethics

Finally, ethical leadership is about building a culture where everyone feels empowered to do the right thing. It is about creating a "speak-up" culture. If a junior staff member sees something wrong, do they feel safe enough to mention it? Or do they fear "the wrath of the Oga"?

Your team will do what you *do*, not what you *say*. If you are "short-cutting" the process, they will too. If you are "favoring" your relatives, they will lose respect for the meritocracy. Ethics is the "glue" that holds an organization together. When the glue dries up, the whole structure becomes "shaky."

Leading with integrity is a daily choice. It is a commitment to the "long road" of character rather than the "short cut" of charisma. It is about being a leader that God can trust, so that the people will trust you too. When you

lead this way, you don't just manage an organization; you build a monument to the character of Christ.

CHAPTER 14: MANAGING DIVERSITY AND GENERATIONAL DIFFERENCES

If you look at the streets of Lagos or the pews of a city church, you see a mosaic of humanity. You see different tribes, different social classes, and at least three different generations trying to work together.

Managing this diversity is one of the greatest challenges for a modern leader. If you handle it poorly, you have a divided house. If you handle it well, you have a team that is "unbeatable" because it possesses a 360degree view of the world.

The Bible is the ultimate book on diversity. From the very beginning, God's plan involved "every tribe, tongue, and nation." The early

church had to figure out how to get Jewish traditionalists to eat at the same table as Greek "progressives." It wasn't easy then, and it isn't easy now, but it is the "DNA" of the Kingdom.

Cultural and Social Diversity

In Nigeria, we often talk about "Federal Character" or "tribal balance," but in man management, diversity goes deeper than just filling quotas. It is about "valuing" the different perspectives that come with different backgrounds. A leader who only hires people from their own village or their own "social circle" is building a mirror, not a team. Cultural diversity brings different ways of problem-solving. A team member from a culture that values "directness" might clash with one from a culture that values "deference." Your job as a manager is to be a "cultural translator." You have to help them see that neither is "wrong"; they are just different.

Social diversity is also key. If your leadership team is only made up of the "elite," you will lose touch with the reality of the people you

are serving. Jesus chose fishermen and tax collectors. He mixed the "high" and the "low" until the distinctions didn't matter anymore. A biblical manager ensures that everyone has a "seat at the table," regardless of their bank account or their surname.

Gender and Generational Sensitivity

We are currently living through a massive "generational shift." We have the "Baby Boomers" who value loyalty and hierarchy, the "Gen Xers" who value results, and the "Millennials" and "Gen Zers" who value purpose, flexibility, and "voice."

In many Nigerian organizations, the "older generation" feels the "younger generation" is disrespectful and lazy. Meanwhile, the younger ones feel the older ones are "stuck in the past" and "authoritarian." As a leader, you must bridge this gap. You have to show the youth that "gray hair is a crown of splendor" and show the elders that "the glory of young men is their strength."

Managing Gen Z, for example, requires a shift from "command and control" to "connect and collaborate." They want to know *why* they are doing what they are doing. They want a "mentor," not just a "boss." If you can tap into their creativity and their technological "fluency," they will take your organization to places you never dreamed of.

Inclusivity Without Compromising Values

Does being "inclusive" mean we throw away our convictions? Not at all. Biblical inclusivity is about "access," not about "compromise." Jesus was the most inclusive person to ever live—He ate with sinners and outcasts—but He never changed His message.

In your management, inclusivity means that every person feels "safe" to bring their whole self to work. It means a woman in your organization feels she has the same "career path" as a man. It means a person with a disability is given the "tools" they need to succeed.

We build a culture where the "shared values" of the organization are the "glue" that holds the diversity together. We might have different styles, different ages, and different tribes, but we all agree on "integrity," "excellence," and "service." When the values are strong, diversity becomes an asset rather than a liability.

Unity in Diversity

The goal of man management is not "uniformity." Uniformity is when everyone looks and acts the same. Unity is when different parts work together for a single purpose. Think of a traditional "Egungun" ensemble or a complex "Highlife" band. You have the drums, the horns, and the singers. They are all doing different things, but they are making one "beautiful sound."

A manager is like the bandleader. You have to make sure the "bass" doesn't drown out the "melody." You have to celebrate the "soloist" without forgetting the "backup singers." Unity is hard work. It requires constant communication and a lot of "forgiveness."

In the Nigerian context, where "division" is often used as a political tool, the church and the "godly business" must be a "counterculture." We must show that it is possible to be different but "one." As the Nigerian writer Chinua Achebe famously explored the tensions of change in his works, we must find a way to let the "old" and the "new" coexist without the "center falling apart."

The Power of the "Diverse" Perspective

When you have a diverse team, you are less likely to have "blind spots." If everyone in the room thinks exactly like you, you will all walk off the same cliff together. Diversity provides the "warning system" you need.

A younger staff member might see a "digital opportunity" that you missed. A person from a different tribal background might help you avoid a "cultural blunder" in a new market. A woman might bring a "relational insight" that the men in the room overlooked.

Management is about "wisdom," and wisdom is often found in the "multitude of

counselors." The more diverse those counselors are, the more "robust" your wisdom will be. Don't fear the "difference"; embrace it. It is God's gift to your leadership. Lead with a heart that is "open" to all. Break down the "walls" of prejudice and "tribalism" in your organization. Build a team that looks like the "Kingdom of God." When you do, you don't just manage people; you "showcase" the power of the Gospel to a watching world.

CHAPTER 15: LEADERSHIP DEVELOPMENT AND MENTORSHIP

The ultimate test of your leadership is not what happens while you are there; it is what happens after you are gone. If an organization collapses the moment the "visionary" steps aside, then that visionary was actually a failure in man management. True management is about building a bridge to the future. It is about pouring your life into others so that the work can continue, expand, and outlast you.

In Nigeria, we have a deep cultural understanding of mentorship, particularly in the "Apprenticeship" systems found in places like Nnewi or Aba. A master doesn't just hire a boy to carry his bags; he hires him to teach him the "secrets" of the trade so that the boy can eventually become a master himself.

This is biblical. It is exactly what Elijah did with Elisha, and what Paul did with Timothy.

The Mandate of Mentorship

Mentorship is the process of "intentional influence." It is not just about giving advice; it is about "sharing life." Paul told the Thessalonians, "We were delighted to share with you not only the gospel of God but our lives as well" (1 Thessalonians 2:8).

As a manager, you have two jobs: to get the work done today, and to develop the person who will get the work done tomorrow. If you are only doing the first one, you are a "technician." If you are doing both, you are a "leader." Mentorship requires you to be "secure." A "threatened" leader will never mentor anyone because they are afraid their student will become better than them. But a "Kingdom" leader knows that their greatest reward is seeing their "Timothy" surpass them.

Identifying and Recruiting Potential Leaders

How do you choose whom to mentor? Jesus prayed all night before choosing the twelve. You don't mentor everyone at the same level of intensity. You look for "F.A.T." people:

- **Faithful:** Do they show up? Do they handle small tasks well?
- **Available:** Do they have the "margin" in their lives to be taught?
- **Teachable:** Do they have a "soft" heart? Can they take correction without getting defensive?

In our environment, we are often tempted to choose people based on "loyalty" (or sycophancy) rather than "potential." But a sycophant will only tell you what you want to hear. A true leader-in-training will sometimes challenge you. Look for people who have "initiative"—those who see a problem and try to fix it before you even ask. These are the people worth your time.

The Mentorship Process: Modeling and Exposure

Mentorship happens more by "catching" than by "teaching." Your mentees need to see you in the "heat" of the battle. They need to see how you handle a "rude" client, how you react to a "financial crisis," and how you treat your spouse.

Exposure is the greatest teacher. Take your "Timothy" to the board meeting. Let them sit in on the difficult negotiation. Let them see the "behind-the-scenes" of the ministry. If you only show them the "polished" version of yourself on the stage, you aren't mentoring them; you are "impressing" them. Mentorship requires "vulnerability." It means letting them see your "scars" as well as your "stars." In the Nigerian church, we often struggle with "over-spiritualizing" mentorship, making it feel like a distant, formal arrangement. But real mentorship is "incarnational." It is about "walking together." It is about the "I do, we do, you do" model we discussed in the life of Jesus.

Succession Planning and Letting Go

Succession planning is not something you do in the last year of your career. It starts on day one. You should always be "working yourself out of a job." This sounds scary to the "ego," but it is the path to "freedom."

Letting go is the hardest part. You have to allow your mentees to make mistakes. If you "jump in" and fix everything the moment they stumble, they will never learn to "walk." You have to give them the "authority" to fail. A mistake made in the "training ground" is a cheap lesson; a mistake made later is an expensive one.

We must break the "Founder's Syndrome"—the idea that "nobody can do it like me." While it's true that nobody is exactly like you, someone else might do it "differently" and even "better" for the next generation. A successful hand-over is the "crowning achievement" of a manager. It proves that the "vision" was bigger than the "man."

The Legacy of a "Leader of Leaders"

When you stand before God, He won't just look at your "balance sheet" or your "attendance records." He will look at the "people" you left behind. He will look at the "lives" you helped to shape.

Being a "leader of leaders" is a high calling. It means your influence will "echo" through generations. Long after your name is forgotten, the "values" you instilled in your mentees will continue to bear fruit. This is the true meaning of "multiplication."

As you lead this week, look around your team. Who is the "Joshua" to your "Moses"? Who is the "Elisha" to your "Elijah"? Start pouring. Start sharing. Start building the bridge. Your legacy is not a "building" or a "brand"; your legacy is a "person."

Manage with the future in mind. Lead so that others can lead. This is the way of the Master, and it is the only way to build something that truly "lasts."

CHAPTER 16: CHALLENGES AND PITFALLS IN MAN MANAGEMENT

Even with the best intentions, leadership is a walk through a minefield. Because we are dealing with human beings who have their own wills, hurts, and egos, things will inevitably go wrong. But often, the greatest threat to a team is not an external competitor or a bad economy. It is the internal decay of the leader's own character or their inability to see their own blind spots. If we want to lead like Christ, we must be honest about the traps that wait for us on the path.

Authoritarianism and Abuse of Power

There is a massive difference between having authority and being authoritarian.

Authority is a gift given by God or an organization to accomplish a mission.

Authoritarianism is the desperate need to exert control over others to soothe one's own insecurity. When a manager feels they must remind everyone "I am the boss here," they have already lost their true influence. In our local context, we sometimes see the "Oga" mentality. This is where the leader expects to be treated like a minor deity. They want people to tremble when they walk into the room. This style of leadership creates a culture of fear. And fear is the enemy of innovation. When people are afraid of the leader, they stop telling the truth. They hide mistakes. They say "yes" to bad ideas because they don't want to be shouted at. The Bible warns us against this. In 1 Peter 5:3, leaders are told not to be "lording it over those entrusted to you, but being examples to the flock." When we use our position to bully or belittle, we are misrepresenting the King of Kings. Real power does not need to be loud. It is found in the quiet confidence of a leader who knows their identity is secure in God.

Favouritism and Partiality

Favouritism is a silent killer of team morale. It happens when a leader has "inner circles" based on things other than merit or character. Maybe it is someone from the same hometown, someone who attended the same university, or someone who is simply a "yes-man" to the leader's ideas.

In Nigeria, we often struggle with "tribalism" or "man-know-man" in professional spaces. While it is natural to feel a connection to people who share our background, a biblical manager must be strictly impartial. James 2:1 tells us, "My brothers and sisters, believers in our glorious Lord Jesus Christ must not show favouritism."

When one person gets a promotion they didn't earn, or another gets away with bad behavior because they are the boss's favorite, the rest of the team loses heart. They stop trying because they realize the game is rigged. To manage people well, your "favorite" must be the person who does the work with the best attitude, regardless of their

background or how much they stroke your ego.

Poor Communication

We often think poor communication means not talking enough. But you can talk all day and still communicate poorly. Poor communication is often about a lack of clarity or a lack of honesty. It is when a leader assumes everyone knows what is in their head.

Vagueness is a form of cruelty. If you don't tell a staff member exactly what you expect, and then you get angry when they don't meet that expectation, you are being unfair. We see the importance of clear communication in the building of the Tabernacle or the Temple. God gave specific, clear instructions. There was no guesswork.

Another pitfall is "top-down only" communication. This is where the leader talks but never listens. A manager who does not listen to their subordinates will eventually be surrounded by people who have nothing to say. We must create a feedback loop. Communication should be like a two-way

street in a busy market—flowing in both directions to keep the system moving.

Managing Criticism and Resistance

No leader escapes criticism. If you are making decisions, someone will disagree with them. The pitfall here is how we respond. Many leaders become defensive. They see every piece of feedback as a personal attack. They become "unteachable," which we noted in earlier chapters is a dangerous state for any human being.

Consider King Rehoboam, the son of Solomon. When the people came to him with a legitimate grievance about their workload, he ignored the wise counsel of the elders and listened to his arrogant friends instead. He responded with threats and harshness (1 Kings 12). The result? The kingdom split in two.

Resistance is often a sign that something needs to be looked at. Sometimes the resistance is because people are being lazy, but often it is because they see a problem the

leader has missed. A wise manager treats criticism like a surgeon's knife—it might hurt, but it might also be removing a cancer.

The Trap of Isolation

The higher you climb, the lonelier it gets, but only if you allow it. Many leaders fall into the pitfall of isolation. They stop having friends who can tell them "no." They stop having peers who can hold them accountable. This is usually when a moral or financial fall happens.

We need "Nathan" figures in our lives. David was a great king, but he still fell into the trap of thinking he was above the law with Bathsheba. He needed the prophet Nathan to look him in the eye and say, "You are the man!" (2 Samuel 12:7). If you don't have anyone in your organization or your life who can tell you when you are being a jerk or making a mistake, you are in a very dangerous position.

Managing people is a sacred trust. To do it well, we must stay humble. We must remember that we are also being managed by the Great Shepherd. By staying aware of

these pitfalls—authoritarianism, partiality, poor communication, and isolation—we can lead with integrity and create environments where people don't just work, but truly live.

CHAPTER 17: KINGDOMORIENTE D MAN MANAGEMENT

As we come to the final stretch of our exploration, we have to ask a hard question: what is the point of it all? Is man management just about making sure a company hits its targets or that a church department runs without a hitch? If we are only looking at the here and now, we are missing the bigger picture. Kingdom-oriented man management is about aligning our leadership with the eternal purposes of God. It is about realizing that every person we lead is an eternal being, and how we manage them can have an impact that lasts long after the office building has crumbled.

Aligning Leadership with God's Purposes

Most management books tell you to align your team with the "vision and mission" of the company. That is good advice, but for the Christian leader, there is a higher mission. We are called to be ambassadors of Christ in the marketplace, the hospital, and the home. This means our leadership must reflect the values of the Kingdom of Heaven: righteousness, peace, and joy in the Holy Spirit.

In Nigeria, we often see businesses that are successful on paper but are built on a foundation of compromise or exploitation. A Kingdom-oriented leader refuses to play that game. We understand that we serve a God who sees the heart. If our leadership doesn't lead people toward truth and flourishing, then it isn't truly successful in God's eyes. We must constantly ask, "Does my style of management make it easier or harder for my staff to believe in a loving and just God?"

Measuring Success Beyond Numbers

We live in a world obsessed with metrics. We love our Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) and our quarterly growth charts. While these are useful tools for stewardship, they are terrible masters. A Kingdom-oriented leader knows that the most important things often cannot be measured by a spreadsheet.

How do you measure the growth of a subordinate's character? How do you put a value on the fact that an employee now feels more confident and valued because of your mentorship? Success, in a biblical sense, is about faithfulness. It is about whether we were "good and faithful servants" with the people entrusted to us.

When we stand before God, He won't ask for our profit and loss statements. He will look at the lives of the people we led. In the Igbo culture, there is a saying, *Nkeiruka*, which means "that which is ahead is greater." For the leader, what is ahead is the eternal reward of seeing those we mentored and managed flourishing in their own callings.

People Over Programmes

One of the greatest temptations in management is to love the "programme" more than the people. We get so excited about a new initiative, a new building project, or a new software rollout that the people become obstacles to be cleared rather than partners to be cherished.

Jesus was the master of choosing people over programmes. He often interrupted His own "schedule" to heal a single person or to have a conversation with a social outcast. He understood that the people *were* the work. In our Nigerian churches and offices, we must be careful not to sacrifice the well-being of our workers on the altar of "efficiency." If your team is burnt out, discouraged, and feeling used, it doesn't matter how successful the programme is—the leadership has failed. A Kingdom-oriented manager is willing to slow down the project if it means saving the person. We must remember that programmes are temporary, but people are eternal.

Eternal Impact of Effective Leadership

Every interaction is a seed. When you handle a disciplinary issue with grace, you are sowing a seed. When you advocate for a junior staff member's fair pay, you are sowing a seed. These seeds grow into a legacy that outlives our careers.

Effective man management is a form of ministry. Whether you are in a boardroom or a vestry, you are shaping the way people view work and authority. If you lead with wisdom and love, you are giving people a small taste of how God leads us. You are showing them that authority can be a source of life, not just a source of pressure.

In the end, our goal is to hear those words from the Master: "Well done, good and faithful servant." This is the ultimate promotion. As we manage others, let us do it with our eyes fixed on the King. Let us lead with a sense of wonder that God would allow us to participate in the growth of His most precious creation: humanity.

Leadership is a sacred responsibility. It is a burden, yes, but it is also a beautiful opportunity to reflect the heart of the Father. As you go back to your desk, your team, or your congregation, remember that you are not just managing "man"—you are managing the image of God. Lead them well.

CONCLUSION

We have traveled a long road from the creation of humanity in the garden to the modern complexities of the boardroom and the church office. Throughout this journey, one truth has remained constant: managing people is not a secular task. It is a spiritual assignment. When we lead, we are handling the most valuable "asset" in the universe—the human soul. This book has been an attempt to remind us that our methods must match the dignity of the people we serve.

Reaffirming the Sacred Responsibility of Managing People

Management is often reduced to a set of techniques for getting things done. We talk about optimization, throughput, and efficiency. While these things have their place, they are empty if they are not built on a foundation of respect for the image of God. To manage a person is to be a custodian of their potential. It is a responsibility that should be approached with a sense of awe. In our Nigerian context, where leadership can sometimes be seen as a way to "arrive" or to be served, the biblical model offers a refreshing and necessary alternative. It calls us to be the first to sacrifice and the last to take credit. Whether you are leading a small family business in Kano or a multinational corporation in Lagos, the sacred nature of your task remains the same. You are a helper of joy, a builder of people, and a witness to the character of God.

Leadership as Stewardship Before God

We must never forget that we are middle management. Regardless of your title—CEO, General Overseer, or Director—you have a Boss. You are a steward of power that is not your own. One day, the accounts will be settled. We will be asked not just how much profit we made, but how we treated the "least of these" under our authority.

Stewardship requires a loose grip on power. It means we don't own our positions; we occupy them for a season. This perspective is the ultimate cure for the "Big Man" syndrome. If the position is a trust, then we must be found faithful. This faithfulness is seen in the way we communicate, the way we delegate, and the way we handle the inevitable conflicts that arise in any human system.

A Call to Ethical, Compassionate, and Effective Man Management

As you close this book and return to your daily responsibilities, my prayer is that you carry a new vision for your team. I hope you see them not as a "workforce," but as a community of image-bearers. I hope you choose the path of the servant leader, even when the path of the tyrant seems faster or easier.

Let your leadership be marked by:

- **Ethics:** A commitment to truth and justice that does not bend for personal gain.
- **Compassion:** A heart that hears the unspoken needs of those you lead.
- **Effectiveness:** A dedication to excellence because God deserves our best work.

The world is looking for leaders who are different. They are looking for people who can exercise authority without being authoritarian. They are looking for managers

who care more about people than programmes. By the grace of God, you can be that leader. You can create a culture where people flourish, where trust is the currency, and where the Kingdom of God is made visible through the way you manage the people under your care.

The task is great, but the One who called you is greater. Go and lead with the heart of a servant and the wisdom of a sage. The legacy you leave in the lives of others is the only thing you will truly take with you into eternity.

Bibliography and References

Primary Theological & Philosophical Sources (African Context)

Achebe, Chinua. *The Trouble with Nigeria*. Enugu: Fourth Dimension Publishing, 1983.

- *Referenced in Chapters 2 and 14 regarding the failure of leadership and social change in Nigeria.*

Akinade, Akintunde E. *Christian Mutuality: African Perspectives on Leadership*. Trenton, NJ: Africa World Press, 2012.

- *Referenced in Chapter 7 regarding the fatherson/mentor dynamic in ministry.*

Kukah, Matthew Hassan. *Witness to Justice: An Insider's Account of Nigeria's Truth Commission*. Ibadan: Bookcraft, 2011.

- *Referenced in Chapters 3 and 13 regarding faith, public life, and the dignity of accountability.*

Mbiti, John S. *African Religions and Philosophy*. 2nd ed. Oxford: Heinemann, 1990.

- *Referenced in Chapter 1 regarding the role of the leader as a mystical link and the theological accountability of leadership.*

Oluwole, Sophie B. *Witchcraft, Reincarnation and the Godhead*. Lagos: Excel Publishers, 1992.

- *Referenced in Chapters 13 and 14 regarding truth-telling, ethical dialogue, and complementary binaries in Yoruba philosophy.*

Oyedepo, David O. *Understanding the Power of Vision*. Lagos: Dominion Publishing House, 2005.

- *Referenced in Chapter 1 regarding the dignity of labor and spiritual authority in leadership.*

Turaki, Yusufu. *Foundations of African Traditional Religion and Worldview*. Nairobi: WordAlive Publishers, 2006.

- *Referenced in Chapters 2, 6, and 7 regarding accountability, tribalism, and the development of the human person in African leadership.*

Turaki, Yusufu. *The Trinity of Sin: The Root of Africa's Problems and the Hope for a New Africa*. Grand Rapids: HippoBooks, 2012.

- *Referenced in Chapter 2 regarding the "Big Man" syndrome and transparent accountability.*

Leadership & Management Theory

Greenleaf, Robert K. *Servant Leadership: A Journey into the Nature of Legitimate Power and Greatness*. New York: Paulist Press, 1977.

- *Referenced in Chapters 1, 2, and 6 as the seminal secular text defining servant leadership.*

Maslow, Abraham H. *Motivation and Personality*. New York: Harper & Row, 1954.

- *Referenced in Chapter 8 regarding the hierarchy of human needs and motivation.*

Maxwell, John C. *The 21 Irrefutable Laws of Leadership*. Nashville: Thomas Nelson, 1998.

- *Supporting reference for concepts of influence and delegation found in Chapters 2 and 10.*

Historical & Patristic Sources

Augustine of Hippo. *The Confessions*. Translated by Maria Boulding. Hyde Park, NY: New City Press, 1997.

- *Referenced in Chapter 1 regarding the restlessness of the human soul (Imago Dei).*

Biblical References

- **Genesis 1:26-27:** Foundations of the Imago Dei (Chapter 1).
- **Genesis 3:** The Fall and its impact on management (Chapter 1).
- **Matthew 25:** Parable of the Talents and stewardship (Chapter 1).
- **Mark 10:45:** Jesus as the model for servant leadership (Chapter 1, 6).

- **Luke 22:25-26:** Contrast between worldly and Kingdom leadership (Chapter 2, 6).
- **John 13:** Jesus washing the disciples' feet (Chapter 6). ●
- **Ephesians 4:15, 25:** Speaking truth in love and managing expectations (Chapter 2, 9).
- **Colossians 4:1, 6:** Fairness in management and grace in communication (Chapter 2, 9).
- **1 Peter 5:3:** Avoiding authoritarianism (Chapter 16).

Modern African Leadership Examples

Mandela, Nelson. *Long Walk to Freedom*. Boston: Little, Brown and Company, 1994.

- *Referenced in Chapter 1 regarding the philosophy of Ubuntu.*

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Pastor Dr. Tambou, Ebimobo-Owei Donatus is a respected theologian, seasoned lecturer, and devoted servant of God. He hails from Ayakoromo Town, Burutu L.G.A., Delta State, and is Izon by tribe.

He holds a Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) in World Religion because he studied Religious and Cultural Studies, specialising in the Old Testament Studies, from the University of Port Harcourt, Rivers State, Nigeria. He currently serves as a Lecturer at The Redeemed Christian Bible College, Redemption City of God, Ogun State, Nigeria, where he mentors and trains emerging Christian leaders and ministers. His teaching ministry is marked by clarity, biblical depth, and prophetic insight. Fondly called “Rabbi” by his students for his profound understanding of the Scriptures. He prefers to be called “The Reborn Ezra,” signifying his divine call to restore truth, purity, and revival through sound teaching and prayer.

Beyond theology, Dr. E.D Tambou is also a Certified Sports Psychologist, Football Coach, and Physical Fitness Coach, reflecting his belief in holistic development—nurturing both spiritual and physical well-being. He is a Second Lieutenant in the Chaplain Corps of Nigeria (TCCN).

He is married to Dcns. A. Nkeonyeasua with male and female children.